

Class Notes: Phylum Annelida

Animal Kingdom • PU-I Biology • Class Notes

Body Organisation and Segmentation

May be aquatic (marine/freshwater) or terrestrial; bilaterally symmetrical, triploblastic, coelomate, organ system level, with metamerically segmented bodies. Locomotion by longitudinal and circular muscles; parapodia present in aquatic forms for swimming.

Locomotion, Excretion and Examples

Circulatory system closed; excretory organs are nephridia; nervous system has paired ganglia connected to a double ventral nerve cord by lateral nerves. Reproduction is strictly sexual; some forms dioecious (e.g. Nereis) while some are monoecious/hermaphrodite (e.g. Earthworm and Leech). Examples: Nereis (clam worm), Pheretima (earthworm), Hirudinaria (leech).